

"Modern poetry claims to be a vision, that is to say, a knowledge of hidden, invisible realities. It is true that the poets of all times & all places have said as much. But Homer, Virgil, or Dante insist that their poetry has to do with a revelation that comes from outside themselves: a god or demon speaks through their mouths... The modern poet declares that he is speaking in his own name: he extracts his visions from within himself. The disturbing disappearance of divine powers has coincided with the appearance of drugs as bestowers of the gift of poetic vision. The familiar demon, the muse, or the divine spirit have been supplanted by laudanum, opium, hashish, & more recently, Mexican drugs: peyote (mescaline) & hallucinogenic mushrooms."

—Octavio Paz

"If at some future period of the world's history men should acquire the art of flying, there can be no doubt that migration would become the custom, and whole nations would change their localities. Man has, indeed, been always a migratory animal... What men do only at intervals birds do frequently, having greater freedom of movement."

—Richard Jefferies

—Tropeiro, tropeiro, schlep your thoughts
together.

—Bring me something Oriental, something
foreignclever.

1

Where are you Child?
Are you in the Tall Grass?
Can you see the Planet's Currents in its
arcing Bent?

What brings you leave of Solitude?
Is it the Waves of Wild Oats—
Or just the way they hide you?

Are you avoiding Supper and its Fam'ly
inquisition?

Are you worn out from Covert Games with
the Other Children?

I too have found a Sweet Relief in
Prospect & in Refuge
Have wished to live outside Surveil &
Rest my rusted Mettle from the reckless
petty minds that meddle...

2

—The tothead thinks—

Yet only lifeless worlds are blind, &
everyway we go beheld,
With watchings that repeat themselves:
that groove
The mind & sense of self.

All the open lines and tethers, open fronts
you drink at night & wounds you
probe and question with a queasy
finger...

3

7:10 São Paulo—
Centered cell of numbered seats,
A sleepless press of bodies
Strain against constraint, containers.

By descent a mindwreck,
Neck-kinked, bleary, drifting
Back & list toward slipspace sorted rows;
then

Watch an ad to hop on public network,
Sell a stare for signal;
Call a cab & grab a coffee,
Summon carriage, Japanese revival;
Gridded beats from global Starbuck station:
Shape my mouth in novel ways to
Make the sounds which soon will come so
Easily:

—Bonjia, um cafe com leite—
—Crêjito; sim, por favor—

A simple favor, would you? Paltry
Pretense, game politeness, pass my plastic—
Skip the tip in strange, familiar waters—
Same old roles in same old Latin.

4

Up all night that night at
Plastic tables, round red tables
Kicking back & clinking glasses with the
Little cups, that make litrões seem so
abundant.

Myself a dark-eyed junko down at Barra
Fundá,

Watching wildlife the milling
Rites while Toby reads the room, like
David

Attenborough, Austen, Doyle:
Footwear, fannypack, the style accents
assets.

-Couple'a feelers, bottle of fizz-
-Headin' for boil; simmerin' rizz.-

You get a sense at once, he says-
The head-to-tae assembled parts.
Harmony in poetry, I link & show a
spectogram-
The bassy din & many tongues
fastswallowed words;
I strained to speak of prairie dogs,
Who pip a sentence in an instant
Vertisplayed as chord.

-All the girls in little black dresses
-Touch their lips and twiddle their tresses.

Our chatathon, with frontseat tickets:
Cars pulled up unloading friends
And leaving, loaded up on lovers;
Others coupled on the concrete,
Some third wheel spun feigned absence,
Privvy to some ancient cycle:
Hot-girl summer; cuffing season.
The dance had little hold
On husbandeyes wine-darkened,
Garden-gained, & knowing well the nature
Of fermented fruit: Still,
Imagination burnished,
'Liding all the effort burnt
In tactics and confusion.

-So close, so far, from Camp Elis
-A sunken floodplain, skeet release.

Unreal City-Cryptic aerosol alphabet-

Climbing past the pichação, its
Pretty pieces-Some provincial up to heaven.

Afterwards, well. I go home, and smoke
on the street and give butt to
a beggar. I drink a yoghurt
and watch a guy go crazy, just
screaming drunk in another man's
face. Spot someone squat, and
shit on the pavement and kick it,
like a dog. I've been going round,
photographing the inside of trash
cans; I've been interested in a
neighborhood's waste, in its disposal
systems, in its use of clear &
colored bags.

And I find O'Hara's "Personism"-surfing,
back in bed, to fill the empty
pre-dawn. Looking for voices; still
not liking the sound of my speech,
& mimicking music of others.

And because all these foreign placenames
make me think of Frank,
Who loved to write his lines like letters,
I settle it then & there, to write this poem
to
Ariel, my brother, Cris, my boyhood self.

5

-As the laundry women'd say-
-Amante especial, oi vei-

At the service counters, clients
Tracking comedramas of their catenary
Clientele (for if one must thus pay
attendance,

Ought enjoy the bought performance.)¹

Anteros had flown down, hence the chatter:
We were in the process
Of deciding where to live,
And how. A course of trips to tell:
From New World to the Old;
From yesteryear's province now tomorrow's
core;

We wanted a Latinate language;
Wanted a neutral passport, in event of
war.

Two to three dozen inches of rain;
Warmish weather pear-round and a little
land,
To call our Kingdom;
Nonstop flights to Newpork, for our
Short-run social re-up missions.

It was hard, projecting yourself
Into some imagined future—
Guessing at the form you'd take on
fifteen years and half a million bucks.
The more we saw, the more it seemed
arbitrary,

Where we settled. Spreadsheets helped
To take the Romance out of Romance
language.

O My Goldenfleece Girl; on your last day
We drove to Camburi, down the coast—
I was virgin when it came to açai, you
know,

We first time really getting it,
And the gilded stray who limped, before we
Lept from solid rocks to flowing pool below
and

Used the roots like ropeswing in the

¹ And if one plans to buy a pair of pants, one
Ought as well to get them tight, so anyone'll bed you.
—O'hara, "Personism"

Magic hour's aur'ate spray.

Of course we all thought of Tarzan—
We'd all seen the movie, hadn't we?—
And the mere mention of tu/can lent a
scent
And charged the scene of our descent with
possibility.

Ô Mãe d'Água—
Early morning rising singing
Walking sandy sickle, bullion shore,
Along the veined & fatty sea &
feeling young, eternal perched on
Billion-year-old boulders, under ancient
skies & all the
Tidelines marked by barnacle, &
Not me crying, "Not this time!"
To loneliness, who many times before had
tried
To wash upon these rocks of mine.

6

And driving long the skyway,
When the tunnel opened up on such big
blue
We played a Bushy "Big Sky"—Kate's—&
sang along, all
Shouldershaking—
Lost in flows, we nearly drove right off the
ledge.

And then dropped at the airport poor
Anteros—
Actually, she took a car.
After she was gone I rearranged the dining
room.

Turned the TV on Megachurch &
Christian infomercial.

And I went to work for many hours,
In the darkness, under HVAC—hum,
& neither ate nor left until the sun rose
On the third of days...

Then so giddy, kicking, skipping on the
sidewalk,
Like San Xobal, singing
Mama, Mama, Mama
Don't take my kodachrome away.

My mustache died a perma-purple, sipping
those elixirs.
Such good times, I'd stumble downstairs
past the doorguard
find a table on the sidewalk, wait to say
The same words every time, a joy just
getting right:
—Bonjia, todorem. Dois ovos, sim,
mesquidos—
—E cafe com leite—e um suco com laranja,
por favor—

And most times getting what I'd wanted,
hoped and tried for.
Well, I won't trouble you with a theory
of language
But it felt like singing, and it felt like
magic.

And Cris? We were to spend a month
together.
He'd been learning to read the city—
Blockquote, concrete syntax, gridded layout.
Taking the same walk everyday & seeing
what happened—
How the parts fit—Perce counting cars—
He was writing about Parisian corn carts:
About mass & readymade units adapted
Into custom forms, over years and
generations.

He was interested in
lightweight/portable/nomadic
architecture.

In minimum-viable rigs.
The natural, everyday look of lighter
Coverage could not fool him.
He always noticed people's shoes;
I mentioned frost, abroad.
An exlover in Janeiro—
"That's the thing about Cris; he's
always looking."
She said he was a gringo, for the way he
wore his fanny pack.
(Insufficiently guarded).
She said he was a gringo, for translating
"polvinho" to
Tapioca dust.

7

Heaven's hammock lulled us
Singing long to Dylan
Merica's new folk song canon:
"Graceland," "Country Roads" & Newman

Bobby with his breathless beat-rap²
Cosmic Cassady, ecstatic
Dana Ward and Manley Hopkins
("Leaden Echo," read by Burton)

"One who sings with tongue on fire":
Lit by Guthrie, lit up Davy;
Lizardking is flying, crying
"Girl, we couldn't get much higher."
So a network relays power.

As kingfisher bares its breast,
And embers wake by oxidation,

² Swinton's Roland-Knausgaard nods—"No final form
enclosed him."

Musement warms a mailed loin, and
Collins, dissertating terms,³
Built networks in ergetic transfer:
Motion motivates emotion.

—Mitchell splices plus & minus;⁴
—Mary's doctor galvanizes.

(Frankenstein the café site of
Beatnik luau—bamboo hat, a Byron goat's
Leading sixteen—something babes in
Martial forms of meditation:
Fifties haunt Laguna Beach In geometric
visitation.)

And what profits prophet?
Fasting, foreign soils;
Substance, contemplation?
Fasting, isolation, altered states & novel
inputs;
Excess to perturb the system;
(Cycle—slain not far from Bixby)

...Avid phrasing... measured breath, a
Trumpet... magic scribbles... blowing on a
subject;
Anaphoric rhythm, vital dash, and speechy
pauses...

Sensitive fellers, indulgent of transient
desires.
First thought right thought,
Cocky chestpuff,
Messi instinct improv,
Camp'd Mars athletics.

8

The local network covered Cris's gym.
Reporter came around,
Everyone was real excited.

She said, You're our new leder:
Climbing is the new Tinder.
The youth were meeting in person,
It was a big story.

—Oh, sure, a global trend
—Maybe you caught it—
Got me in with a guestpass—
We watched them work their form & plan
their routes &
Build their bodies. Some attempted
ledger—record,
Testing Heavens; Some gave lessons,
To pretty girls,
And others ground their grip strength.

And when the weather was good?
Sneaking in the med school's pool—
Peering through the windows long the path;
Lessons learned on grappling mats,
Strength in opposition training;
Girls & boys in volley courts for
trophied golden
coated brass...

Green oasis waters: emptytranquil,
sun-warmed waters.
Then the clockstrike, with its
~~WYANDERCAMPAIGN TO MORE~~
Cueing mass migration. Here comes
everybody

first, the piscine plain is
Subdivided / so: the open / water's made
to

Lanes by stretched & twining wireflow, &

³ Randall, *Sociology of Philosophies*.
⁴ Joni, "Electricity".

Swimmers take their place by speed &
Space is hieraragui'd.
How easily we come to share
When lines / are laid / on pavement bare.

Or stand erect in humus soil, constancy
abetting coil,
Letting life know air...

9

But now on darkened streets I pass the
Feeding troughs, & all the faces turned
w/in,
Toward shout & flag & colored card w/
Preassigned allegiance.

10

We were primitives of a future unknown.
Hot oats mixed with champagne mango:
So much better than I'd imagined
Butter helped.

You put the mask in masculinity, she said,
drying off with a towel.
The clouds above seemed to form a lattice;
They covered and uncovered the sun,
Light showers coming in and out,
Cooling us, drying us.

We went to the pool almost every day:
Framed lens. Banned rays. Inspecting
Marbled fat & muscle hung on hook &
strap & rack & splayed on slab &
dripping up on blocks or oilslicked or
stripped pink for braising bruising
browsing here a brisket breastkid

there a tenderloin, a leg so plucked
& plump, a tempting aged shank a
lean appraisal, stretching tanning
hide and charring sear, a prime
cut, check her measures make an
offer—

Stop!
These degenerate games,
They get me down.

11

—Grā Grayhouse, grow like grāo &
upgrade.—

Chlorine cleansed us.
Toweled-off to sunshowers,
Mechanized carriage past Água Branca,
Villa Country's block of falsefront bars
With cowhide seats & leather saddles,
Chandeliers of purchased antlers.
Cris didn't register the appeal;
I toured the spot by satellite that night,
And prepped for 'piacaba, playing out a
podcast
Taking notes—I swore it'd be my best
performance—
Hoped to ~~ARP~~: Like All Romantic Poets,
long-past
("Dead" in sense but somehow speaking)
To see what it was like, I guess,
(I knew a girl from Barnard loved her
cats above the rest.)
And if the form might suit me with some
tailoring, I guessed.

And learned, for instance, Hopkins was born
to a marine insurer,
Who safekept lords 'gainst the wreck of

their craft,
But could not spare a crew or captain.

(Like bark, must get the wind in me,
The breath in me, of God & West &
Pass it on to others:
Sparks must fanned be, to become fire.)

A Catholic, Manley—haunted by a woman's
resurrection:

Winifred, whose wellspring sprung up
where beheaded.

(Willowrun: A downward flow allows an
upward growing
Long the bank of fallow fields, waiting for
their sowing.)

Byron, Shelley, Polidori: Peacocks,
Theban poets—

Boating with the boys while Mary
watches—

This is what I learn, for instance, from
Distelli on the speakers—

These Romantics not romantic
Much beyond the Year of Cotton.

Harriet? Was not invited—

Riverdrowned, a Virgin's pebbles—⁵

Godwin's wishful thinking tested;

Bob & Toni's offroad freedom

Slave to courtship, Hudson's Stetson...⁶

A doubt: And who am I to play at
rockstar?—

Long digression—The plan was—
To walk, drink tea & mumble in the wood,
Half-savage in an Industrial Age,
And sing to birds, & squeak a caller's zinc
on birch,

And make strange sounds meant for myself,
And treat the voice as instrument, as men
before had done

But mostly tried & failed
(Mine would be another failure)
To make of type a moltenmetal—
Blended space a better place—
Which was not dissimilar
To the brass instruments
Of my youth.

For how the fretless trombone flummoxed.
Yet a student's slide is taped, and
All its open space is snapped to
Gridded notes correct, implying in their midst
an error.

I was always finding my positions,
To keep in tune with teammates:
Metal merely modulates what's buzzing in
the mouth.

And insofar as brassy Scats were—must
it be said?—

A new Romantic.

But also in the Wakean sense of harmony,
Where each word is really three or four
or five words spliced—

Were all part of my new theory of
practice, which I called vox libre,

Its manifesto penned at lunch,

As Frank did it,

Or really in the House of the Owls, Rome
And developed in Trattoria Luzzi.

And which only a few people know about,
And less understand.

—Snap from drift & dry the hands on
dishrag—

—Sigh lightly—

—Have to skip again I guess—

—Tap through time by working back in

⁵ p. 1. 03. 28

⁶ Rock's Rex, Willow Talk

increments of ten.
Keats, at least, was protean and modest,
Like the song of starlings,
Cupped self to carry world,
Bring the outside in.

Wordsworth, though, an egoist—
Pistelli here a moralist—
His poets more like alchemists
As Jung conceived them:
Soulsmiths, much as wordsmiths;
Mimicked, modelled mindset,
As Girard would then perceive them.

—Wahatchu looking at? Shit.—
And why'd you speak the subtle thing out
loud?
In flurried snow is buried Robert Frost,
New England's famed pasture poet.
All a means to butter parsnips.

Whose reading was lowercase catholic;
Who leafed through anthology;
Who sought to know & move all kinds:
Here are the pearls that were his eyes:
No caviar! He sought a subtler
Quality in tonal tenor, shied from all
Performance of his learned reference.
How his rusted tributes like a standard
shame me.

New leaf; another ten and ten;
Wetfingered triple-tap to learn
That poets were athletes, men of physical
prowess.

Humble men, these minstrels.
Wishfully wanting to be any but
themselves:

To be farmer, fisherman, boxer or smith.
Sweat over ink-stain, Earnest ol' Olson,
wrestling bulls.

(A labor of the hand, a poem, like
rhythms of a scythe while swishing
meadows:

Softly spoken, cutting down the ranks. I'm
on a digression but how do I get
used to the everyday violence of
gardening, is what I'm always
asking. Because there's something
fascist (no?) in pruning branches,
weeding roots. Well. I've gotten
away from plot, and will the editor
kindly leave these?)

Ten and also Robert studied talky rhythms
(So did Ginsberg. So did Gaddis.
Frankie surely; Bobby)

Listened to their music, tried to imagine how
they'd sound through walls,
Freed from con or denotation, muffled—
Almost molten—out of all distinction.

Pound had showed him jiu-jitsu, sure, in
Eager silence—showed him bohemia,
flipped him head & heel in some cafe.
Frost was just as strong; he hadn't been
ready.

Just as clever as Pound, just as wellread.
Read more Greek than Pound, he reckoned.
His American shoes—they gave him away.
Knew more Latin, so his friends said.

An instinct, deep within him, said to stay
away from gangs.

He never forgot Ole Ez tho.
Busted him right the heck outta jail,
Settled it with the big A.G., just like that.
That's what you get for being famous.
When you're poet for the lawyers, and not
just fellow poets.

13

That was fifteen years ago.
Send my roots your rain, O Lord,
To write one work that wakes.

But on half-sunny days I find
A higher kind of hedonism:
Bougainvillea, staging of me own
transcendence:
Peak at plastitropic lower canopy through
lover shutters.
Smile warm to traduttore traditore
Hostess of her hometown:
Tories sleeping in the kitchen.
(There's a law against that.)

So smooth she is in service
Seen our kind a hundred times before and
will, again—
We glide up to the bar where she's
Presiding over leisure center,

Move our mouths, per-form for
native-tongue appraisal,
Try not to offend her.

-In the yard os pássaros pause &
pulse-perch-
-Branch to phototropic branch-
-And in the grassblades, guava's windfall-
-Rapid-gathered by the ants.-

That night we many write in Father-ink
that bleeds, among a
Graveyard: matchsticks, blackened splceff
These tubes with charcoal tips, with
Ends that burn & ends that do the burning.

While distant train loops 5ths in 6/,
On a swivel like an owl's neck the
Camera tracks me as I move,
Naked between bed & bath &
Light a cigarette-

Or write, which must be why she said-
-Ele é um escritor-
How now can I act, without performing
for her gaze?
Glamitini, man of mirrors.
(More like topiera.)

14

Do I dare project a self?
And let world fall away?
Do I dare Adam's Act, & fashion handles,
so to wield
Worldforces with a wet & wily muscle,
To repair the pump that vandals damaged,
From whose spring proceedeth science.
How will I choose a form? How will I
choose a life?

When on this morn I cannot choose
between my butter knives.

15

All is long, is long, is long.
All is long-

Every thing talks back, when we're alive
(A heron taught me that.)

Fall asleep in foreign fields,
Foreign drifting slowly yields.

Red fruit in the sun-faced green of the
high-branched tree.

Morning's energetic harvest now announced
by feathered flutes, and

Green sun-panelled flapping fans that move
within the Planet's currents:

Breeze that passes through the guavas,
carries chatting prattle of the
parrots, whistling

"Oh que buceceeno" and "I'm talking
to-ehyou."

And through the branches
Heavenrays-tempted in my
own sick way to say--

Brigado to the old Brigades whose cutting
brought me here today.

Can hear their echo of past presence.

Quiet forms, machete whack!

Of breakerpath, in

fallenstem & structure-

State of the Green Tower, in the

Age of Metal, singing,

-Chattanooga answers / And your ma'am
in Tennessee.-

And the mood changes as the goldleaf fades:
 Cumulated cover which at first relieves will
 now not lift; a
 Cricket trill announces us the end of little
 world, like some
 Rose in garden 'Adonis.'⁷

Invading ginger enters at the clearcut,
 Roadcut, in the slash-mowed marginals,
 Along the barren no man's rock'n'gravel we
 call road.

Which clearing flows through living mesh,
 &

Lets me pass, &
 Contact's always Contact
 With that which Contact's altered.

16

Noon, high noon, thy noon & Tam
 Baked into prehistory—
 Stonesmelted, Don't humming:
 "Well, you wanna get enough sun / but
 not too much."

—Wrest controls back from Pleasure
 Center⁸—
 —Back to business at hand—

Nature as stimulant, intoxicant, another
 drug:
 Starting to get to a point where triunesweat
 unzippers.
 Traveling back to High Noon: to a moment
 of
 Maximum Intensity, when shadows' shields
 at their slightest,

And pressurewaves whose radiation warpeth
 man, and burns him up or out.

Watch flutterfly, and unleafing, ants
 are bringing off the body of a hard-shelled
 giant,
 from the shelledland to tunnelsdug.

Radiation warpeth man; he sees the
 Raptor in the Turkey.
 Nuff to make him paranoid, the sounds
 responding to his presence;
 Scattersquawk of rustling pheasants.

Make it nearly back to town now, at the
 fringes half-reclaimed:
 The Warhead windows where the men made
 bread now tangled green, as
 Heatbeats down upon this unscreened skin,
 Brown as a betel-nut in the morning.

—And I have lived the fates of foreign
 diets in a forgn behavior.—

—A hunch: perhaps I've been infected;
 what I've given, also gotten.—



⁷ Pessoa.
⁸ Teronbone

Eris and I start sharing voice memos and since he's been watching *Twin Peaks*, they're all in the style of *Twin Peaks*,

All of them addressed to some elusive Diane, which is really just the pet-name used to refer to each other.

Diane—

February 27th, 7:45 PM or nearly 20:00.
I've never seen so many trees in my life.

Making my own coffee in the house out here. My host is an exmilitary colonel, 5' 4" and distinctly indigenous, who for years lived among the Yanomami. (Ya-No-Mami.) He showed me his collection of bows and blow darts. They wear bromeliads, made from feathers, upon their arms, as if their arms were tree-trunks.

Somehow they've gotten it into their heads I'm a writer. The Colonel asks me how many books I've written. He says, Only children read books here. Or so I think: We have been communicating by way of coarse & broken pidgin Latin.

Diane—

10:27 AM. Coffee on the kettle. My hosts have offered me a ride into Rio Grande, where I'll catch the train. The Colonel offered but if I wonder if the Señorita is the brains behind the operations—he may be

excommando but she's the family strategist. Was it this easy for blue-eyed bearded Cortez to conquer the hearts of the Mexico? Or plume-capped Pizarro, further south? Poor huéspedes, to slay a host.

The Señorita is a sweet woman, and she is also a mother, who loves her family dearly. Which is what worries me.

Diane—

1:33 PM. I have arrived in Estação Luz and will be catching a car to Jaguaribe. Sorry to hear about the cold. Hoping it's mere coincidence, what with the MCO, if only to assuage my guilt. But cats will keep you up at night, & worsen irritation.

Sunday night sleeper works fine with me. I, too, have had a helluva couple days & could use the R&R. Turns out it's hard work, *ARR*ing as Romantic poet—at least if you come to it with something approaching Protestant ethic. Still, the trip was beyond words—I leave satisfied that I have gotten in and out clean.



18

Mobile storehouse,
 Hip-secured from
 Sticky fingers, artful dodger
 Fur or barb or claw or bristle.

Plunge into a sweating sea:
 Sunbrellas, togas, boas, leis, and
 Tridents, fishnets, highwaist jorts, and
 Devil horns, and angel wings at
 Blocos.

"Are you single?" "Yes"
 Is pure permission
 When a subject's tacit.
 Gabe is here, he says,
 Go drink & piss & french
 In any order; you say:
 If a shark stops swimming...

Small tiff among sardines near
 Startles up stampede, with
 Defense read as offense
 In an escalating cycle...

And all the boys are talking tactics
 "Should I play the gringo? Feign
 pronunciation?"
 Foakleys, funk, & Rita Lecna

Asking for a tongueless kiss
 Then going in for bite.

—Rest now, under stonefruit tree—
 —Notice bottom branches bare.—

Some of us still shy with Western sickness
 speech

Glissandos fallen wrong side of the Yerkes
 & Dodson, think:

"Obliterate this sudden fucking fear, this
 inwardness," while

Chanting stomping rain dance round the
 Water truck as burly men lift
 Longgthicc waterhose & spray a
 Begging sweating bareskinned crowd so
 Loud & rowdy; later on, at lunch
 (For this was still the morning)
 I transform to Jesus by infusion: Smoke
 &

Awning shade & suca, vitaminas e azucar.

19

—Are You Sick and Tired of Being Sick
 and Tired Topy?

—Do You require Speech in Prophets'
 Perfect Tense to shake you from
 your Slumber?

20

Or in January's city,
 Plastic surgeon peccs,
 Cosmetic sex & preening.

—Coughing on the couch by day— The
 goblins eat their takeaway.—

Booze brigade of fairytails march
 Sharing, caring, underground.
 Which echoed loudly like an anthem—
 Others in the tunnels joined them.
 Contagious as a Flemish painting:
 Pieter the Elder, maybe.

Cris provides a live translation
 As the train arrives in station:

—I'd love to pour oil all over your hide—
 —Why? To watch your boomboom slide.—

21

Palm fronds gently dance a hula while
 you're flayed & sizzled.
 Towel-talking, loving language.
 Wond'ring which were perfect popsongs of
 a poem, like
 Frankie's "Coke", and which were perfect
 poems of popsongs?
 Cohen's "Suzy", Joni's "KAL.OST"—
 All of them (not "Drufrock") love-ode.
 While blue ships on a blue horizon
 Read in cross-hatch rival currents.

And shifting gaze past Sugarloaf,
 Toward shaggy loafing lovers,
 Sharing sodas, lemon maté, seasoned meat
 It's mating season, meet'n'greet in pidgin
 Latin.

While blue ships on blue horizon
 Drive toward trucks to trudge loads inland.

—Under pitched sunbrellas:—
 —Picturesque young Cinderellas.—

In portal promise of a paperback partake:
 Omegaverse's wolfish sense of

het-romantasy.

22

Forever & always in the age of glass
 The age of windowshopping
 Love, & sex, in crackt arcades
 A tablet trance to faraway beach
 In this, our Touring Twenties,
 Vesty, wanderyears sans wonder,
 Picqued by pretty pictures,
 Waxwing slain on false azure,
 On subtlgridded portal promise,
 Shallow light reflecting depth there.

23

That night catch bossa in the old cantina;
 Cold beer lifting heat like evening
 Breeze, & kiddies craning cameras
 Skin as brown as betel-nuts, and
 Airy hymns from half-caught cras.

And midnight on the Sambodromo:
 From our chairs we chatted
 Charted floats slowprogress
 Chanting crowd incanting chorus
 Loud & rowdy
 Cheering stars who flaunt & shake &
 Flow to rhythmic current
 Down the corso's
 Shoreline, costumed cosplay torsos
 Fest of fat and fleshy skin and
 Winkless sleep slowsetting in,
 The Sun King and his sinking Queen
 Their crowns of rays
 Their solar spokes arrayed
 In radiating angle

Tended by a bend of angels
 Featherwingèd, free of fetters
 Wringing salt from festive tatters
 fire-singed and filing, singing
 (Not trivial in tropic weathers)
 Wending toward the barricades, the
 Great brigades of cosplay tribes, the
 front-row seats secured by bribes.

"O céu vai clarear
 Iluminar a zona oeste da cidade
 E Deus vai desfilar
 Pra ver o mago recriar a Mocidade
 A luz que nos chega da estrela primeira
 Nasce do pó no Cruzeiro do Sul
 Do plasma divino das mãos carpinteiras
 Ressurge candeia no breu nesse azul
 Será que o limbo da imaginação
 Perverte a inteligência
 O homem com sua ambição
 Desconhece a razão desatina a Ciência
 Será que há de ter carnaval, sem minha
 cadência?
 Com alas em tom digital
 No fim da existência
 Me diz afinal quem há de arcar com as
 consequências?"

Se a Mocidade sonhar
 No infinito escrever
 Versos a luz do luar, deixa!
 Quando o futuro voltar
 A juventude vai crer
 Que toda estrela pode renascer

O verde adocido da esperança
 Ofega sobre o leito da cobija
 Quem vive pelo preço da cobrança
 Derrama sua lágrima postiça
 Fogo matando a floresta
 Bicho morrendo no cio

Febre no pouco que resta
 Secam as águas do rio
 E a vida vai vivendo por um fio
 Naveguei
 No afã de me encontrar eu me emocionei
 Lembrei da corda bamba que atravessei
 São tantas as viradas desta vida
 A mão que faz a bomba se arrepende
 faz o samba e aprende
 A se entregar de corpo e alma na avenida."

24

Carne-leave: Roman remnant diasporic
 fatty Tuesday excess 'fore the lean-mean
 Wednesday Lent.
 But here the party never ends.

We bid farewell to flesh and set out towards
 some
 Beautiful Horizons, in the General Mines.
 Pack padkos for the journey;
 Morning spent in Burlé's garden:
 Genus sung to Jagger's violent
 ictus-accent,
 Every beat in stress:

-Lit/tle In/di/an fig,-
 -Where is your ownnnnn skin?-



And near a chapel perilous, on sugarcane
plantation hill,
O thousand-trunked tree all webbed &
curtained
By your symbiotes, your rounded staghorn
scales, browning 'bove
Bromeliads, which brace & cup your
branches, catching rain.

Learn of leite politics while driving
Through the lactate kingdom of a lesser
time, a
State a stage in process, forming,
History informing, never blank-start always
twisting
Writhing, snaking; breaking down the self
To build another up:

"Curral, cabresto, comitiva
Tropa, tronco, guided gridd
Eito'n'lavoura, grooved carreira in alignment
Oscillating oligarchs in
Vin'n Vang collapsing
Milk from young Republica, &
Frothed en gran fazenda..."

By lateish afternoon we'd reached
Hill country, pastureland where
Shimmerwaves wind-racing cross the faces,
Silver quickflow in the fore as

Pearl-lined clouds enormous,
Currentpulled with all the rest, peck Godly
light,
While we atop indifferent engine,
Bubbleglass enveloped barely sense it.
Cris puts in his upper-decky soaring
Carving in through shadowpatch and
piebalds,
Unfenced ungulates, us setting out to
Cuntry

from the Seedy, Os Mutantes, male
movement.

And underneath the hanging vines—
A chessboard, gridded black & white &—
Inlaid into concrete table.—

Then drove from old Petrópolis, where some
long-lost writer lived & died & got
a street named after him.
We play Genesis to Exodus, & skip
around Ecclesiastical to Solomon,
on Bluetooth speakers; & I asked:
How far is proverb anyway, from catchy
everyday cliché?
(Well, Cris said, a chiliad. We left it
there.)



The Beats wrote odes to Menfriends,
Breaking from tradition—
Troubadors and Bedouins—Instead—
Sung ballads of heroic age to
Celebrate the courage of their boys, in
War with the Machine.

And of mereness at night bejewelled
 By other steersmen, ancient world.
 Hard to not see God herein the pasture.⁹

25

Sitting on a park bench, Tiradentes, when
 you texted.
 Said: "To feel the cool of rain & heat of
 sun at once—
 That is a higher pleasure"

This lucky duck gets to see a
 Sun dog on phanerothymes, gets to see an
 Abbiocco in breeze-blocks, while Cris
 Reads out on his Anki.

Perched among the stonecypflower,
 Starseed, phototropes while
 Roots reach down, commensurate
 With upward motion—
 Sky-grasp by a strong foundation—
 And speaks of fabled Trásil lightness,
 Burdened less by static contracts—
 In support he quotes Calvino;
 Cards to read in native language.

26

Scavenge, deconstruction zone
 On red pared that leads uphill
 Unto the Church of Anthony,
 Of thousand feathergold rocailles
 Plant-dyed red rocococo.
 On laudinum, my thoughts turned in—
 choate and porous, reading old

⁹ Secession from modernity. Regression to an earthworm
 life among mildew peasants, types the Heron, bored.

inscription
 "Laud him thus in chord & chorus, organ,
 corpus"
 Golden awe by self-description.

Walls all packed with whale, grass
 And cowshit, hardened mud, the
 Greeks, Chinese, & Arabs carved, so
 Slanted eyes on half the cherubs
 Hybrids of império era.



And ninety days by mule for music,
 Putrefactive oozing up from
 floorboards for the patron's pleasure
 Incense lit in steamy weather
 Brides brought in bouquets to stifle
 Smell of death with life, or something close:
 The cellulose of life-stem snipped
 And stripped of lignin, pressed
 In sheets to take impress, collect
 In this anthologize & wrecking prize:
 Ninety days by mule.

27

O Ariel!
 How have you become so heavy?
 Bound in arborescence
 By maternal witch.

When will you surge aerial,
And sing a higher pitch?

O Ariel:

Now though you serve a better master,
Still your heart beats faster
At a word like "free".

O Ariel!

A rebel angel, & a cynic
Overcome by Abdiel,
The zeal of religious zealots.

So much I would say, would I saw Ariel.
Walking peat, Fennario.

O Ariel—

Thou hast been a Camel, once;
Now thou art become a Lion;
When the gyre turneth around,
Thou shalt be as Childe.

28

—Be Still A Moment Childe—
—There are lessons still to learn here.¹⁰—

Psychedelic wobble,
Creek-cut corso through the
Jungle-lush & tangle.

Then passed vicious dogs
I fended with a walking stick
Toward cachoeiras, catch ya later;
And cut past termites' orange adobe,
Old adobe, domed adobe,
Roman concrete secret,
Sunbaked & stigmergic.

¹⁰ Heronbore, "Vegetable Empire": "Wait. Stay a while.
There is more to be explored here. / Acceptance at this
point creates a lull. Wait here."

Up through red clay beaten
Into stepwell, looping bootstrap, shæ-tie:
Culpture's thousand hardened heels' press
&

Gaia's thousand soft'ning rains.

Lessons like: No architect—
Just compounding gesture—
Can discretize a slope so smooth, a
Thousand selfish steps,
The flat spots picked for further pounding,
In desire's trails
Discretize a smooth slope
Into stairway's righteous angles.

Up & up, past shaggy growth
on undergroove of roots,
in shaded grove, & up
Where breeze keeps trees in arcs of
temporary tension,
Keeps the crying hawk in circling
suspension,
With a voice that carries menaces,
Where the prey-lings flutelike chirpings
cheer us,
Little watchlings, watch our power, spill
our beans:
Time current-carves, and stacks in stone.
Accumulates and then erodes
As walkers of a trail lay the trail down
again;
And all the pretty stones on paths are
plucked & pocketed.

29

Flipflops like a Roman sandle
Oiseaux exotiques and
Sunbaked brick & vibora in slitherbrushes
Crossing such a path was

Dudley, young fool Dudley, heel-bitten."
 Getting lost in small-scope stories
 Getting lost in grandlarge stories
 All anxieties are here, in
 Reconciling disparate, the
 Gap, in checking correspondence,
 Keeping up with inbox.

In the frame and interruption
 Jagged lightning boltbreak from
 Satchitananda.
 Went to stay forever in a single second,
 but
 Distances demand traverse, connections
 made, & anyway
 Heaven like all company doth spoil in three
 days, Kairosclerotic, so will you
 Find my path? My dear pathfinder.
 Art like any art, an
 Art intending & attending—
 Quiet now, and notice here:
 What patterns hast thou seenest ere?
 A virgil in the forest dear.

30

"My God! The Source!" you cried from
 high,
 Shouting Robertin Trwin lines on
 Optics over roar of falls, the
 New ideas slow-swimming into focus,
 Watching white rush carving,
 Black rock shaping
 "Structuring structure, which is structured
 By the flowing force it structures."
 Swingvines, far from latticework of
 leftbehind city.

I say:
 "In other words, everything changes
 everything else!"
 Which is half true, but feels great in the
 moment to say,
 Really strong and powerful, thinking how
 These impressions on the senses etch in
 memory,
 Informing here the words I'm forming
 Channeling a groove in minds of
 Readers—Yours—

31

No Simple Trick Nor Secret, Child—
 Just to notice, not to shy from
 Truth, intentional attention

Tactics you can borrow,
 Sssssssure.
 Mechanisms to adapt sure but—

But what?
 Each problem different;
 Different goals & gods & sense of good &
 Different setting,
 All the background we're forgetting

Every act unique transform
 From global state to state
 To state in mécanique form
 Not just billiards sure
 But what else is change, if not
 The pawning mouth of rivers?

So many words & phrases coined
 In efforts to control the waters,
 Intellect and OODA passionate
 expression

Which in simplest term was life, adapting,
reconfigured
Form to meet & match the form that formed
informed sees.

32

Vesca in the hammock:
Cricketquiet,
Beetlebreaze & birdcall
Smalltown silence,
Ruffled branches' windfall
Whispered dogfight
Butterflies like biplanes
Particles' positions showing
Hidden currents
Like the hawk atop a thermal.

And all the birds in bin'ry rhythm
Perch, suspend, & perch again
Perch & fly &
Rest & risk & rest again
Glide, exert & glide
Til distant thunder scatters.

Buffeted by current flows
& ebbs recurring subtly like
Fortune's fastest layer fashioned
from what shoreward ocean washes.

In the morning, up early,
walk & autosong &
paracosmic play that's interrupted by a
century of beetles, still on glassy pool,
nearby below electric bulbs,
and flat against the windshield.

Cris kicks his legs in chlorine,
Tells me how a Language is a set of
Patterns,

And the Patterns are the building-blocks
Of all the story Traces that we tell.

33

Says Cristobal, this region's known for
climbing, then corrects my accent:
"Meu nome é Cristobal"
I say, fair enough but good luck iambs,
Other rhythms here resisting meter.

"Check the slicker" he says,
But no palheiros.
When I ask for climbing handholds
What I get are handles:
Crimps & jugs & pockets & rails,
In-cuts, slopers; slippp, chaussy, glassy.
Then he gives one of his infamous reports
from the interior.

Remember: Back in Brooklyn,
Cris had drunken-staggered
(Was a tipsybuzz at best;
This telling's fond of its excess)
-All this money, what does it buy you?
-All are heavy, drugged up the wazoo.

For gain o' grain they banner-band together

Like Liberman had felt, regreso
from thatched Filipino rooves
And breeze blocks
"My people full of lightness

-It was something like: A relaxation.
-It was something like: A lesson
in negotiation.

Recall-
(Proleptic analepsis) bite o'

Meatbeer breakfast, bar o'
Mushroom chocolate—
Parque nauseous, weathered under bower,
Dozenmile walk,
Sip finest rums on Thames
(All overproof) &
Sideline goofing.

"Some folks are just like that— Treasured
by the Gods & better
Off avoiding effort."
(Others in the darkness drill,
Chisel stone to timeless still.)

And me?
A screaming Carioc
Til dawn—
The rain, the fortune's sons
The blueridged mountains, rolling
Rivers, smokehoarse
(Jeff had mimicked Satchmo)
Then, hungover, hair of
Most exquisite science:
Heronbeast—hysterie naked,
Raving nightswear, bedwet—
"Brotha!"

34

We were frecks.
We were labrats in labrintime.
We were sufferers of zugunruhe.
We were epicormic buds.
Damage to the main trunk activated our
waiting phototropism.

We sped cuntry to seedy,
A classic migration.
Cycling makes analepsis proleptic amidst

Dyplling cars and the echoing birdcalls,
A kind of uniformitarianism,
Prophet's perfect tense not far from
carved stone-time: —Wenn du mich
siehst, dann weine—
Which it was to Kerouac, in "Big Sur",
A fall, like killing Cain, who founded cities,
That book is a book about projecting your
perception onto a landscape,
Like thinking the Heavens were a great dome
overhead,
And then learning of yourself, through the
glints of light that bounce back.

—But how do you choose your form?—
—How do you choose your name? How do
you choose your life?—
—How do you choose the time you must
exhale—
—And kick, and rise?—

In the same way us & all the pungs
Tempted by the views of light that shine
through screens
Of distant wildlife, missed encounters,
curtained parties
Work our way in labrintime and towards
it,
Missing great white light that shines
through keyhole polymorphous
No final form, said Knusgaard—
And what, then, might I risk becoming?

Triune darkness at the edge of town.
Distant Bladerunner ziggurat,
Back to the City of metamours and kipple
Vopodyne & Mordor
Where they eat numbers
Where shiny people dance to shiny music
And gather in the Afters
Of the snake 'n ladders of careers.

And me-voidward, narrowcast & murd'rous
Megaphone midst failson & faildaughter,
Slow beset by paterdreaming
pitter-patter.